INCIDENT MANAGEMENT

Incident logging and resolution

Persona and pain points taken from the project Empathy Map

Service Desk Agent

SCENARIO

Logging, updating and resolving an incident on the Incident form

Steps
What does the person (or group) typically experience?

Interactions
What interactions do they have at each step along the way?

Goals & motivations
At each step, what is a person's primary goal or motivation? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")

Positive moments
What steps does a typical person find enjoyable, productive, fun, motivating, delightful, or exciting?

Negative moments
What steps does a typical person find frustrating, confusing, angering, costly, or time-consuming?

Areas of opportunity
How might we make each step better? What ideas do we have? What have others suggested?

Report

How does an incident first reach the agent?

	Receive issue from caller	**Open new Incident form**
Steps	A caller reports a problem by phone, email or portal and the agent starts logging it.	The agent opens a new record on the Incident table.
Interactions	Phone, email or service portal	Incident form in the ServiceNow platform UI
Goals & motivations	Help me understand the problem quickly	Help me start logging without delay
Positive moments		Familiar form layout opens quickly
Negative moments	Callers give limited or unclear details	
Areas of opportunity		How might we show required fields up front?

Log

What does the agent do as the record is created?

	Enter caller and Short Description	**Select Category and Subcategory**	**Set Impact and Urgency**
Steps	The agent types a short summary of the issue.	The agent classifies the incident so it can be routed.	The agent rates how many users are affected and how soon it must be fixed.
Interactions	Caller and Short Description fields	Category and Subcategory choice lists	Impact and Urgency fields
Goals & motivations	Help me capture the issue in a few words	Help me route the incident to the right team	Help me reflect the true business effect
Positive moments		Choice lists make classification fast	
Negative moments	Rushed entries leave vague or one-word descriptions	Subcategory is skipped, so incidents are routed wrongly	Impact and Urgency are guessed under time pressure
Areas of opportunity	Block submission when Short Description has fewer than 10 characters (onSubmit)	Make Subcategory mandatory and show Assignment Group when Category = Software (UI Policy)	How might we guide the agent with clear choice labels?

Triage

How is the incident prioritized and routed?

	Priority is calculated	**Assign to group**	**Add work notes for critical incidents**
Steps	Priority is set from the Impact and Urgency combination.	The agent confirms the Assignment Group for the resolver team.	For Priority 1 - Critical, the agent records extra detail for the resolver.
Interactions	Priority field on the form	Assignment Group field	Work notes field
Goals & motivations	Help me trust that priority is correct	Help me avoid reassignments	Help me give the resolver what they need
Positive moments	Priority fills in instantly with no extra clicks	Assignment Group appears when it is needed	
Negative moments	Manual priority does not match Impact and Urgency	Wrong group causes tickets to bounce between teams	Critical incidents are saved with no notes
Areas of opportunity	Auto-populate Priority from the matrix on change (onChange) and keep it read-only		Make Work notes mandatory when Priority = 1 - Critical (UI Policy)

Resolve

What happens as the incident is worked and closed?

	Update the incident	**Set state to Resolved**	**Add resolution work notes**	**Submit the record**
Steps	The agent adds progress details as the work moves forward.	The agent changes State to Resolved once the fix is confirmed.	The agent records what was done to fix the issue.	The agent saves the incident.
Interactions	Incident form and Work notes	State field	Work notes field	Save and Update buttons
Goals & motivations	Help me keep the record current	Help me close the incident correctly	Help me document the fix for others	Help me submit without errors or rework
Positive moments		Resolving feels like a clear finish		A clear error message explains what to fix
Negative moments	Updates are skipped when the queue is busy	Incidents are resolved with empty notes	Writing notes feels like extra effort at the end	Records saved with missing data surface later in reports
Areas of opportunity			Require Work notes on Resolve (onSubmit)	Abort submission with a clear message and keep the entered data

Review

What happens after the incident is resolved?

	Resolver reads notes	**Manager reviews reports and SLA**
Steps	The resolver team reviews the record to act on it.	The manager reviews incident reports and SLA performance.
Interactions	Incident record and Work notes	Reports and SLA views
Goals & motivations	Help me see the full story at a glance	Help me trust the numbers
Positive moments	Complete notes save follow-up calls	Consistent data makes reports reliable
Negative moments	Missing details force the resolver to contact the agent	Inconsistent priority distorts reports and SLA results
Areas of opportunity		How might we extend the same controls to other fields and tables?